’Til We Meet Again

Paul’s farewell is not merely a closing — it is a benediction, a commission, and a promise: the God who called you is faithful, and He will finish what He started in you.

Where this study fits

1 Thessalonians · ten studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–5
An Introduction to the Thessalonian Church

02 1:6–10
The Many Faces of the Gospel

03 2:1–12
Delivering the Gospel

04 2:13–20
A Successful Life of Service

05 3:1–13
Facing Tribulation

06 4:1–12
A Life That Pleases God

07 4:13–18
The Rapture of the Church

08 5:1–11
The Coming of the Lord: A Purifying Hope

09 5:12–22
The Coming of the Lord: Exhortations

10 5:23–28
'Til We Meet Again

"Finally" (4:1) marks the hinge: chapters 1–3 lay the foundation; chapters 4–5 turn that theology into life.

Six parting words

1 Thessalonians 5:23–28 · Outline I–VI

A **Mediation · v.23**

“May the God of peace Himself sanctify you completely”

B **Declaration · v.24**

“He who calls you is faithful, who also will do it”

C **Application · v.25**

“Brethren, pray for us” — three words

D **Reception · v.26**

A holy greeting — nobody leaves unrecognized

E **Exhortation · v.27**

Read to all — the Word must reach everyone (ἐνορκίζω)

F **Benediction · v.28**

“The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you”

Three aspects of sanctification

1 Thessalonians 5:23 · I.A–C — from 1 John 3:2–3

A

Our past

“Now we are children of God” — positional, permanent

1 John 3:2a

B

Our promised

“We shall be like Him, for we shall see Him as He is”

1 John 3:2b

C

Our present

“Everyone who has this hope … purifies himself”

1 John 3:3 · Paul’s emphasis

ἁγιάσαι to sanctify — aorist: the work seen whole · optative: a prayer, not a prediction

Can we see Jesus now? Yes — on the pages of Scripture. Beholding Him, we are being transformed (2 Cor 3:18).

Spirit, soul and body — wholly

1 Thessalonians 5:23 · I.C — Our present sanctification

Spirit — vertical
πνεῦμα pneuma · G4151

- The part that communicates with God
- Only human beings have it

Soul — horizontal
ψυχή psychē · G5590

- Our relationships with others
- How we love, serve and carry one another

Body — the instrument
σῶμα sōma · G4983

- The means by which we do it all
- Sanctified to God, used by God

ὁλοτελεῖς wholly — “completely to the end” · found only here in the New Testament

Walvoord: “Our physical bodies, our spiritual or intellectual life, and our psychological or natural life are all part of this sanctification process.”

“He who calls you is faithful”

1 Thessalonians 5:24 · II — A parting declaration

What we cannot do

- Sanctify ourselves
- Be totally sanctified in this life

What God does
πιστός · καλῶν faithful · calling

- He is faithful — covenant dependability
- He keeps calling (present tense)
- He will do it

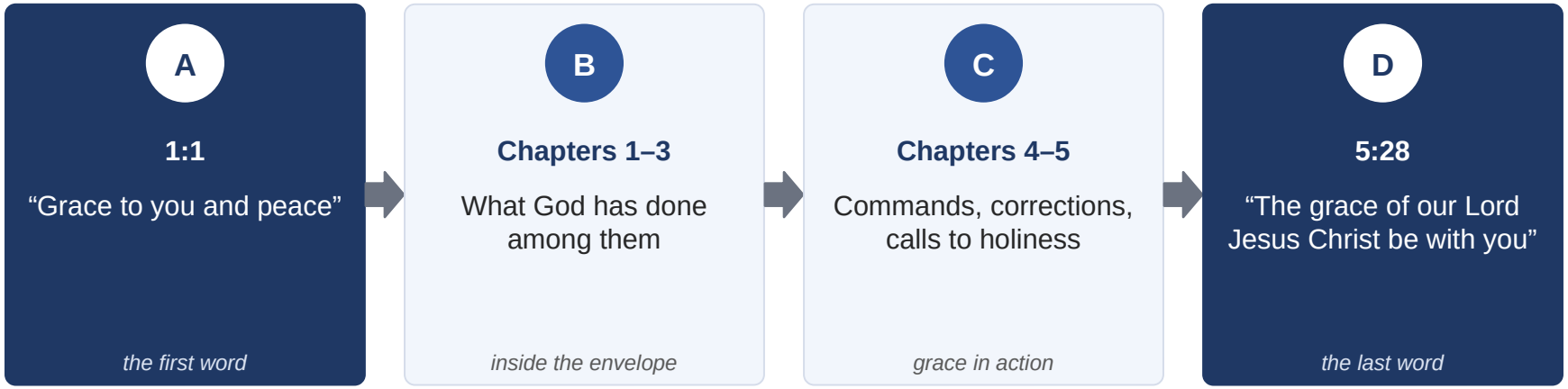
What we must do

- Make ourselves available
- Stop resisting
- Behold Him in the Word (2 Cor 3:18)

Philippians 2:12–13: “It is God who works in you both to will and to do for His good pleasure.” He makes your willer will and your doer do.

Grace at both ends

1 Thessalonians 1:1 and 5:28 · VI — A parting benediction



The angels who sinned	vs	Fallen man
• Saw God’s power and justice — never His grace		• God sacrificed His own Son — grace

Discuss and apply

1 Thessalonians 5:23–28 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. The commentary finds three aspects of sanctification in 1 John 3:2–3 — past, promised and present. How does holding all three prevent thinking we are already perfect — or that we must make ourselves perfect?

2. The letter begins with grace (1:1) and ends with grace (5:28). How does grace as the frame shape how we read every command and correction in between?

Apply

Make Yourself Available

Name the one area where you've been pulling back from God, take one step of yielding, and tell someone.

Live from Grace — Not toward It

As a group, write one sentence: what God has done among you through 1 Thessalonians. Post it.

In one line: He who calls you is faithful and will do it — grace at the start, grace at the end. Here, there, or in the air.